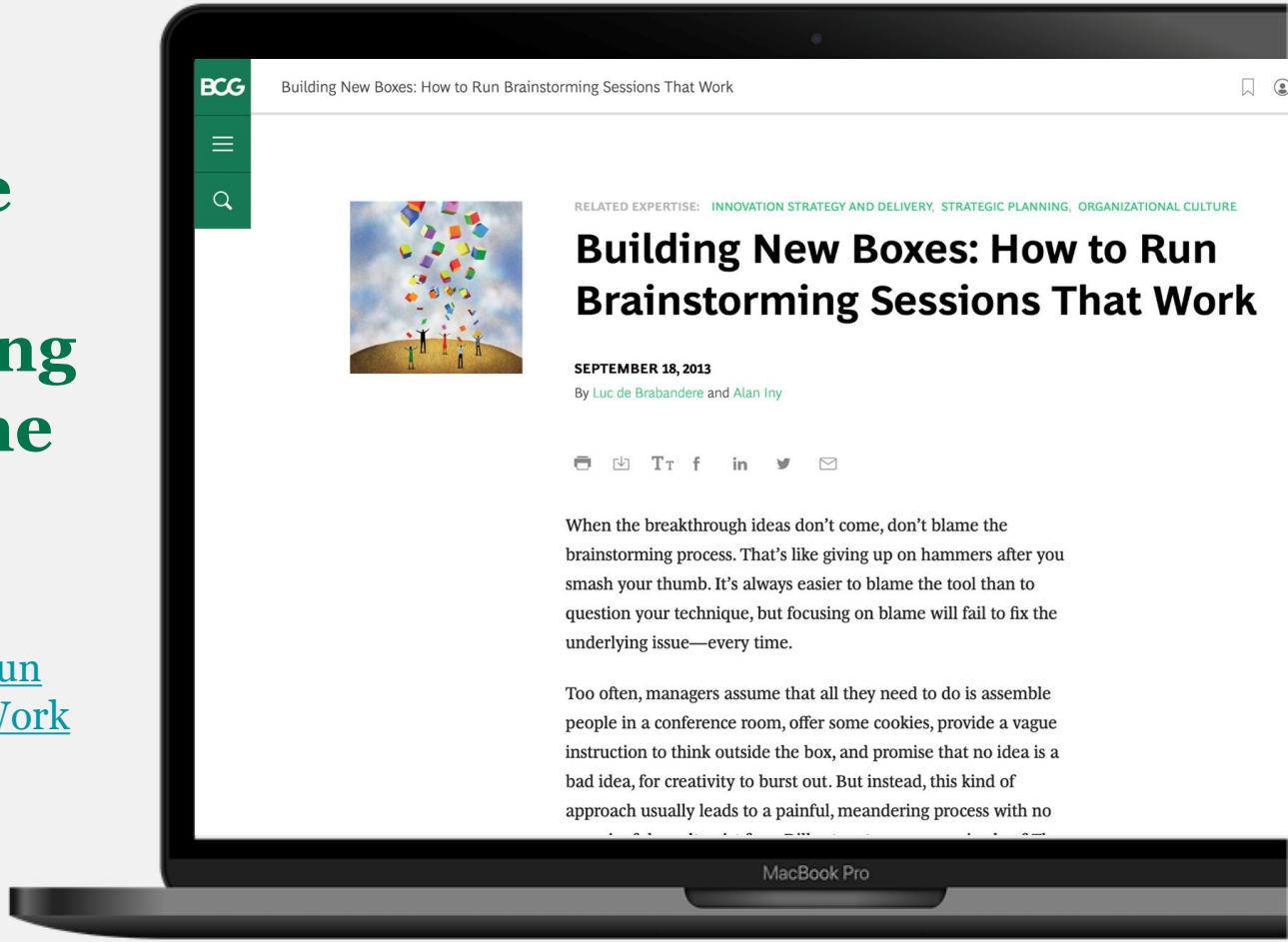
Building new boxes

We are going to discuss effective brainstorming. Start by reviewing this article on the BCG website:

[Building New Boxes: How to Run Brainstorming Sessions That Work]



The article offers five suggestions to achieve real, valuable insights from brainstorming

We will focus on three of these in today's task (as well as the brainstorming itself), highlighted in green

1. **Frame the question effectively**

2. **Create creativity conditions**

3. **Reveal and doubt your boxes**

4. **Bring new boxes**

Brainstorm

5. **Follow up**

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Building New Boxes: How to n Brainstorming Sessions Tha ork

SEPTEMBER 18, 2013

By Luc de Brabandere and Alan Iny

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Your task

BCG has been brought in to help ClothingCo, a luxury clothing brand, grow their top line (i.e., increase revenue) after a period of declining sales.

The client is gearing up for the winter season. Imagine that you are a strategy consultant working on the project.

You will enter your responses in the green boxes throughout the remaining slides.

Frame the question effectively

"If I were given one hour to save the planet, I would spend fifty-nine minutes defining the problem and one minute resolving it."

– Albert Einstein

Question to be reframed

How could we sell more outerwear this winter season?

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Revised, effective questions:

1. How could we get high-income urban customers to purchase premium winter outerwear this season?
2. How could we create urgency for customers to buy luxury outerwear before peak winter?
3. How could we increase repeat purchases from existing customers during the winter season?

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Remember: A good question for brainstorming will be narrow and concrete, so that people feel they know how to begin answering it.

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Reveal and doubt your boxes

In this fictional scenario, make assumptions that seem reasonable

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What boxes currently exist that are still relevant?

1. Luxury customers value exclusivity and premium quality
2. Brand image and heritage are key drivers of purchase decisions

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What boxes currently exist that need to be doubted?

1. Sales must primarily happen through physical retail stores
2. High prices limit accessibility and customer base
3. Winter sales depend only on seasonal demand

Bring new boxes

New box #1

Digital Luxury Experience

Description:

- Customers are willing to buy luxury products online
- Digital channels can deliver premium experiences
- Personalization increases conversion rates

New box #2

Accessible Luxury Expansion

Description:

- Entry-level luxury products can attract new customers
- Younger consumers value brand association
- Volume growth can complement exclusivity

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Brainstorm

Question	How could we create urgency for customers to buy luxury outerwear before peak winter?
New box	Digital Luxury Experience

- Launch limited-time online exclusive winter collections
- Offer personalized recommendations using AI
- Introduce virtual try-on features for outerwear
- Run early-access sales for loyal customers
- Collaborate with influencers for digital campaigns
- Provide fast delivery and easy returns

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